> destiny. Palestinians are losing their own lands. They lived there and the migrants expelled them from there [Palestine].[32]

In 2004, Dzhemal and Shevchenko participated in a round table in the aftermath of the assassination of Hamas leader Sheikh Ahmed Yassin. Shevchenko called for giving Russian citizenship to at least 1.5 million Palestinians to increase Russian involvement in the Middle East and to defeat the pro-Israel lobby in Russia.[33] In January 2009, Dzhemal and Shevchenko signed the declaration of the Coordination Council in Support of the Struggle of the Palestinian People that described the Palestinian struggle as an example of "honor and dignity" for all humankind, and claiming that the United States by the hands of "Israeli butchers" kills thousands of Palestinian children, women, and the elderly.[34] In April 2012, a demonstration by pro-Palestinian activists took place in front of the Israeli embassy in Moscow. Among the speakers were Dzhemal, Shevchenko, and Nadezhda Kevorkova (Shevchenko's wife and comrade-in-arms). Shevchenko stated that Palestinians are the symbol of a common Christian-Muslim union against Israeli aggression and the Russian (*Rossiiskii*) people should help them: "We will not allow the enemy to crush the Palestinian people, exactly the same way as we will not allow the enemy to crush the multinational Russian [*Rossiiskii*] people."[35] Kevorkova emphasized the physical suffering of the arrested Palestinians, denouncing Israeli brutality:

> They [Israelis] place Palestinian prisoners—women, men, the elderly, and children—with bound hands, legs, blindfolded on a small baby stool, and leave them in this position for 2 to 3 days. It is difficult to believe. After that, they place a sack over the head of the bound person and seat him in a bus where for days they play the same melody, usually a western one. It is especially difficult for the Palestinian children because it impacts their psyche. It was done to break their will.[36]

She also told the audience that Israelis practice medieval torture on the rack, and keep prisoners in small ice chambers for as long as twenty-five years.

Shevchenko's pro-Muslim positions (including criticism of some aspects of Russian policy in the Caucasus) led to a confrontation with Russian Nationalists and neo-Nazis, among others. In 2011, when Evgenii Satanovsky, the director of the Moscow-based Institute of the Middle East, attacked Shevchenko's pro-Islamic lobbying, he counterattacked by asserting that Satanovsky's dual citizenship made his loyalty to Russia suspect. Moreover, he stated that Satanovsky and other political scientists having Russian and Israeli citizenship, behaved in Russia like "representatives of the colonial

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